

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared on a travel blog:

Taking selfies is becoming more dangerous, study finds



The next time you are standing at the top of a waterfall, take care when you have the urge to snap a quick selfie. It could be the last thing you do. More than 250 people worldwide have died taking selfies in the last six years, according to a new study.

Researchers found the leading cause of selfie-related deaths to be drowning, followed by incidents involving transport. For example, falling from a cliff into the sea below or taking a selfie in front of a train. Other causes of selfie-related deaths are taking photos with live animals. A German woman was recently killed while taking a selfie with an elephant.

The report noted that while the simple act of taking a selfie isn't dangerous in itself, the problem arises when people take risks while trying to get that perfect shot. It also pointed out how many of the selfie-related deaths involved young people. More than 85 per cent of the victims were between the ages of 10 and 30. It was difficult to confirm the exact number of people seriously injured or needing medical help, but the researchers believed it was extremely high and growing every year.

Selfie-related deaths have now become a serious safety concern.

You are a member of the school photography society. Your group has been asked to discuss problems caused by selfies. You may want to talk about:

- why selfies are so popular
- the dangers caused by taking selfies
- why people are willing to take such risks
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do people take too many selfies?
2. What are interesting places to take selfies in Hong Kong?
3. Is it only young people who like taking selfies?
4. Will selfies remain a popular trend?
5. Do you think no-selfie zones will be introduced in the future?
6. Do you think no-selfie zones will be effective?
7. Apart from the risk of injury, what other problems do selfies cause?
8. What makes a good selfie?